H. HANA KWON

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EDUCATION

Harvard Business School — Boston, MA
Pre-doctorate in Strategy and Entrepreneurial Management — Present
Working with Profs. Andy Wu, Ebehi Iyoha, Jaya Wen

Columbia University — New York, NY
M.A. in Quantitative Methods in the Social Sciences (Data Science) — 2026
Advisor: Prof. Laura Boudreau (Economics, Columbia Business School)

Seoul National University (SNU) Business School — Seoul, Korea
M.S. in Strategy and International Business, *Summa Cum Laude* — 2024
Thesis Committee: Profs. Theresa Cho, Sun Hyun Park, Joon Mahn Lee
Highest Distinction (Ranked #1 in Cohort) in Master's Graduation Thesis Review

Korea University — Seoul, Korea
B.A. in English Language and Literature — 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Innovation, Frontier Technology, Political Economy, Entrepreneurship.

SELECTED RESEARCH

Kwon, H.H., & Wu, A. **"Critical Input Control and Technological Leadership."** *Research design stage.*

Asks when control of an input that an entire technology depends on, such as the high-bandwidth memory Korean firms supply to the AI industry, becomes leadership in that technology. Against the prevailing view that such suppliers gain most by selling to every downstream producer, the study hypothesizes that they integrate forward, as BYD moved from batteries into cars, only when the input's margin falls below the value they can capture downstream and they already hold the complementary assets the downstream technology requires. U.S. export controls on advanced chips (2022) and high-bandwidth memory (2024), which cut some suppliers' sales to China more than others', provide the variation to compare downstream investment, acquisitions, and patenting.

Iyoha, E., & **Kwon, H.H.** (2026). **"Configuring Artificial Intelligence in Multinational Enterprises: Managerial Capabilities and the Gains from Adoption."** *Under review at Global Strategy Journal.*

Examines how multinational firms combine AI expertise with existing managerial capabilities. Using workforce and financial data on manufacturing multinationals, the study asks whether the gains from AI adoption depend on where AI employees are located relative to managers, linking the geographic configuration of new capabilities to firm performance.

Kwon, H.H. "The Technology Clock: Expected Arrival and Investment Timing in Deep Technologies." *Proposal under review at Organization Science.*

Asks whether a field's stated arrival date for a deep technology moves closer as the technology progresses, and whether firms whose expected arrival moves closer invest earlier in patents, hiring, and partnerships. Starting with quantum computing, a language model extracts dated arrival estimates from 2,247 passages in 1,222 company earnings calls; Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang's January 2025 remark that useful quantum computers were 15 to 30 years away provides a field-wide shock to expectations. The measurement is being extended to the U.S. government's list of critical and emerging technologies.

Kwon, H.H. "AI Moats? Proprietary AI and Durability of Startup Advantage." *Proposal under review at Organization Science.*

Asks whether building AI in-house still confers advantage once comparable capabilities can be bought from a few foundation-model providers, as they could after ChatGPT's release. Language models read the pre-ChatGPT archived websites of more than 60,000 startups founded in 2017–2020 to identify those that claimed proprietary models, data, and customer relationships. Linking these measures to funding and hiring records, the study compares startups that built their own models with those that relied on external technology, before and after ChatGPT, across markets where foundation models can perform more or less of a startup's core work.

Kwon, H.H., & Iyoha, E. **"Reading Politics, Making Strategy."** *Proposal under review at Organization Science.*

Studies how firms decide what to expect from a political leader's statements and whether that expectation warrants action, during the 2025 U.S. tariff shocks. A language model codes 44,607 passages of dated statements on the same questions small-business owners answer in a survey; a planned experiment follows expectations and supplier choices over 180 days.

Wen, J., Lensman, T., & **Kwon, H.H. "State vs. Market-Oriented Innovation."** *Research design stage.*

Studies how market incentives and policy priorities shape firms' choices about where to direct innovation, using provincial leadership data and technology plans in China.

OTHER WORK IN PROGRESS

Iyoha, E., **Kwon, H.H.**, & Satchu, R. "Letting Options Go: Commitment under Uncertainty" *Data analysis stage.*

Studies when people stop paying to keep weaker options alive and commit to the option their experience supports, using a game in which some options pay more the longer one stays with them and unused options expire. A two-wave online experiment tests whether personalized feedback on this behavior changes follow-through. Co-investigator and study coordinator.

Kwon, H.H., & Cho, T.S. (2026) "Which Recalls Become Company-Level Events? Product Recall Disclosure and External Evaluation." *Manuscript in preparation.* Extends [9].

Kwon, H.H. "Scientist Mobility and Recombination of Expertise." *Data analysis stage.*

Studies whether incoming scientists' expertise helps existing researchers address their own problems or redirects research toward the newcomers' agendas, using careers and publications around moves from U.S. to Chinese research institutions.

Kwon, H.H. "Organizing Evaluation in Science." *Proposal under review at Organization Science.*

Studies when an approval leads users to trust work more than the review behind it justifies, using a test bed that sends the same AI-generated work, with planted errors and a known answer key, to each evaluation structure.

PUBLICATIONS

[9] **Kwon, H.H.**, & Cho, T.S. (2024). "Market Reaction Following Corporate Crisis: The Role of ESG Performance & Crisis Response Speed." *Academy of Management Proceedings, 2024(1), 11914*.

[10] Hwang, K., & **Kwon, H.H.** (2025). "Sustainability for Survival: Strategies for Korean Battery Makers in the European Market." *KIET Industrial Economic Review* No. 24/IER/29/06/03 (KIET, SSRN).

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Harvard Business School, *Predoctoral Research Associate* Jul 2025-Present

With Prof. Andy Wu (Strategy Unit): AI, Technology Strategy, Entrepreneurship

- **AI Bubble.** Drafted an article and developing research on value creation and value capture in AI.
- **AI Wars 2026** *(HBS case).* Contributed to research on the AI industry's competition and strategic partnerships.
- **Entrepreneurial Projection Strategy** *(Aticus Peterson, NYU Stern).* Supported research on how startups use revenue projections to establish credibility; ran a human-coding study to validate LLM-based industry classifications.

With Prof. Ebehi Iyoha (EM Unit): AI Adoption, Entrepreneurship, Emerging Markets, International Trade

- **RADIA Project: Generative AI Adoption and Innovation in Emerging Markets** *(Abdoulaye Ndiaye, NYU Stern; HBS AI Institute).* Contributed to firm-study design, classification of African AI startups, and a talent-misallocation framework; research assistance on a working paper on AI talent in multinational enterprises.
- **AI²: A Hypothesis on Artificial Intelligence and African Industrialization** *(Abdoulaye Ndiaye, NYU Stern).* Supported research on whether AI can raise aggregate productivity by making advanced organization affordable for smaller firms, using firm evidence from Kenya and Nigeria and a model of organizational choice.
- **The Role of Foreign Venture Investors in African Startups** *(with UNCTAD).* Supported research on whether employment rises after Sub-Saharan African startups raise venture funding and whether that depends on foreign investors.
- **Frontier Technology in Frontier Markets: Financing the Global AI Revolution** *(Abdoulaye Ndiaye, NYU Stern).* Supported research on the products, workforces, financing, and investors of 116,675 startups across seven world regions.
- **AI Diffusion in Developing Economies: Scale, Sourcing, and Business Use** *(Abdoulaye Ndiaye, NYU Stern; Abdulkhalid Salihu, CSEA).* Supported research on how small businesses in nine developing economies, focusing on Kenya and Nigeria, use AI.
- **Trading on Ideology: Small-Business Sourcing in the 2025 Trade War** *(Zoe Cullen, HBS; David Atkin, MIT).* Built linked trade and political-data panels and DiD and event-study code on how owners' political orientation shapes sourcing responses to tariffs.
- **Product Bundling Project: Multi-Product Transactions in International Trade.** Supported research on why small importers buy several products from one supplier, using Mexican import records (Panjiva, 2012-2019) and a model of costly supplier search.
- **Exchange Rate Pass-Through and Transaction Timing** *(Walter Steingress, Bank of Canada).* Reproduced and audited analyses of how transaction timing shapes exchange-rate pass-through in Colombian trade; implemented agreed specification changes.

With Prof. Jaya Wen (BGIE Unit): Political Economy, Innovation, International Trade, China

- **Export Controls and Innovation in Sanctioned Countries** *(Xueyue Liu, Yu Liu, Alexey Makarin; HBS WP 25-004).* Proofread the manuscript.
- **Vietnamese Rerouting Project: Trade Rerouting and Production Relocation during the U.S.-China Trade War** *(Ebehi Iyoha, HBS; Edmund Malesky, Duke).* Developed a methods note on imported content in exports and reviewed the manuscript.
- **Public Displays of Alignment** *(Zi Yang Kang, University of Toronto; Joris Mueller, National University of Singapore).* Replicated analyses of why Chinese firms echo government language in annual reports and investigated discrepancies in the reported results.
- **Trust and Democracy: Political Stability in Times of Economic Crisis** *(Nathan Nunn and Nancy Qian; NBER Working Paper 24187).* Reran the replication package to check a replicator's report of missing table columns.
- **Golden Tax Project: The Dynamic Effects of Computerizing VAT Invoices in China** *(Yu Liu, Fudan University).* Rebuilt empirical analyses and extended the Chinese manufacturing firm panel on how digital tax enforcement affects compliance and firm behavior.

Columbia Business School, *Research Assistant* 2024-2025

- **Nationalism in Digital Marketplace** *(Prof. Lori Yue, CBS).* Built firm-level data and coded nationalist self-presentation for research on why small businesses use nationalist rhetoric in partisan marketplaces and whether it supports their survival.
- **Corporate Socio-Political Activism around Black Lives Matter (BLM)** *(Profs. Lori Yue, CBS; Soomin Cho, UCL).* Built and validated executive-level panel data (CEO and top management team characteristics) on corporate responses to Black Lives Matter.
- **Return2Work Project** *(Profs. Mabel Abraham & Derek Brown, CBS; Russell Sage Foundation Presidential Research Grant).* Built the experimental sample and supported pilot outreach and analysis for a field experiment on work arrangements and candidate interest.

Institute for Social and Economic Research and Policy (ISERP), Columbia University, *Research Assistant* 2024-2025

- **Relational Contracts Project: Simulation Modeling of Game Theory** *(Prof. W. Bentley MacLeod, Economics, Yale).* Developed a repeated-game simulation model to study how trust and cooperation emerge in ongoing relationships under uncertainty.

Korea Institute for Industrial Economics & Trade (KIET), *Researcher* 2024

- **Semiconductor and Energy Industrial Policy Research & Future Mobility Innovation**. Co-authored policy research on how Korean battery firms respond to changing U.S. and European industrial policies; contributed to national policy proposals and case studies of semiconductor, clean-energy and mobility innovation, including the study of mobility innovation in the Korean automotive industry.

Center for Global Business and Research, SNU Business School, *Research Assistant* 2020-2024

- **Technology, Corporate Growth, and Innovation Strategy** *(Prof. Jaeyong Song, SNU).* Supported panel research on Korean MNEs.
- **Innovation and Regional Cluster Case Studies** *(Profs. Jonghoon Bae & Booyeol Kim, SNU).* Developed comparative studies of regional innovation clusters from interviews with East Asian entrepreneurs and government and firm-level data.
- **Computational Text Analysis for M&A Research** *(Prof. Seok Hyun Hwang, HKBU).* Applied topic modeling and sentiment analysis to corporate filings to measure acquirer-target cognitive similarity.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

[9] "Market Reaction Following Corporate Crisis: The Role of ESG Performance & Crisis Response Speed."
Academy of Management (AOM) Annual Meeting, Chicago, IL (peer-reviewed; invited oral presentation) Aug 2024
Strategic Management Society (SMS) PDW, Seoul (peer-reviewed; invited oral presentation) Jul 2024

M.S. thesis (SNU): "Effect of ESG Performance & Crisis Response Speed on Market Penalty & Firm-specific Risk."
SMS Annual Conference, Istanbul (peer-reviewed; invited oral presentation) Oct 2024
Korean Society of Strategic Management Conference, Seoul (peer-reviewed; invited oral presentation) Nov 2023
6th Global Conference: ESG Management & Sustainability, Seoul (poster) Nov 2023

POLICY RESEARCH

Hwang, K., Cho, C., Baek, M., Kang, B., & **Kwon, H.H.** (2024). *Technology Strategy and Regulatory Responses in Clean Energy & Battery Industries: Policy Proposals in Response to Changes in Global Energy & Battery Industrial and Trade Policies*. Republic of Korea Policy Report, KIET. Available on KIET and National Knowledge Information System.

Hwang, K., Lee, E., Lee, S., Baek, M., & **Kwon, H.H.** (2024). *Innovation Strategy and Cluster Development in the Renewable Energy Industry: The Case of Pohang Valley Tech Hub*. Republic of Korea Policy Report, KIET.

SCHOLARSHIPS, GRANTS, AND AWARDS

Research Grant, Institute for Social and Economic Research and Policy (ISERP), Columbia University 2024-2025
Scholarship for Academic Excellence (merit-based), Seoul National University Business School 2020-2023
Research Grant for Best Paper Graduate Student, Korea Social Science Data Archive (KOSSDA) 2022
Association of Emeritus Professors Scholarship, Seoul National University Business School 2020, 2021
Top Consultant Outstanding Performance Award, MSL Global, Publicis Groupe 2019, 2020

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Seoul National University Business School, *Teaching Assistant* 2020-2023

Research Seminars in Strategy & International Management (MS/PhD, 2020); Strategic Management (BBA, 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023); International Business (MBA, 2020); Financial Economics (BBA, 2021); Negotiation (EMBA, 2021)

METHODS AND SKILLS

Empirical methods: Field experiments, causal inference, computational text analysis, NLP/ML, record linkage, survey design.

Programming: Python, R, Stata, SQL, Matlab; APIs/web scraping; Git, LaTeX; LLM-assisted workflow (Claude Code, Codex).

Data: Compustat, CRSP, WRDS, Refinitiv; Panjiva, Dun & Bradstreet, Revelio Labs, PitchBook, ORBIS; DIME, L2 Political; Chinese Annual Survey of Industrial Production, National Tax Survey; OpenAlex, ClinicalTrials.gov, openFDA; LinkedIn, Indeed, Keepa, RocketReach; FRED.

Languages: English (fluent); Korean (native); Japanese (elementary).

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Entrepreneurial Experience

Co-Founder | AI Edu Studio LLC 2023-Present

Launched Yappi, a voice-first AI English-conversation app for children (iOS/Android); In service for a private English kindergarten.

Technology consulting

Developed the go-to-market strategy for Notion's entry into Korea, its first non-English market (2020).

Supported process innovation in Kia's global manufacturing process engineering, including a Google Cloud–based data platform built with Google.

Worked on hybrid cloud (HCI) adoption for Hitachi Vantara clients (2019–2021).

Associate Consultant (IT/Deep-tech/Startup) | MSL Global 2019-2022

Strategy Consultant | Hill+Knowlton Strategies 2018-2019